

Simon Chen

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ACLU National Office

Product and Engineering Division, Technology Department
125 Broad Street, 18th Floor
New York, NY 10004

Re: Application for Software Engineer II (CRM)

Dear Director of Engineering and the Selection Committee,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Software Engineer II (CRM) position within the Product & Engineering division at the ACLU. As a recent Computer Science graduate from Boston University with professional experience building full-stack applications, optimizing relational databases, and utilizing enterprise service platforms, I am excited to apply my technical background to support the ACLU's nationwide mission of protecting civil rights and liberties.

The ACLU's commitment to leveraging technology ethically to grow its supporter base and streamline internal operations deeply resonates with me. A core part of a successful enterprise CRM strategy relies on clean data integration, reliable backend workflows, and seamless automated processing. My professional background has given me a strong foundation in these exact areas:

- **Full-Stack & Database Engineering:** In my software engineering role at RESET Standard, I independently developed end-to-end data integration pipelines using a Ruby on Rails backend and PostgreSQL schemas. I am highly comfortable writing performant queries, processing structured data (such as JSON and CSV), and handling large streams of incoming information—skills that translate directly to maintaining a robust Blackbaud CRM database.
- **API Integrations & Asynchronous Pipelines:** I have hands-on experience building asynchronous data pipelines with tools like RabbitMQ, Redis, and Sidekiq to handle heavy data workloads efficiently without interrupting user workflows. Additionally, I frequently work with third-party API integrations and modern JavaScript frameworks, ensuring I can comfortably support the ACLU's cloud-based application ecosystem and handle spiky data workloads during critical fundraising windows.
- **Enterprise Tooling & Collaboration:** My experience working in IT for Boston University gave me direct exposure to enterprise platform management via ServiceNow. This taught me how large organizations utilize centralized, cloud-based software to manage workflows, track system incidents, and facilitate cross-departmental operations. I am comfortable working alongside both technical developers and non-technical fundraising teams to turn operational objectives into clean, documented technical features.

I am a collaborative team player who values diverse perspectives and thrives on solving practical data and software problems. I would love the opportunity to discuss how my full-stack experience, SQL background, and passion for the ACLU's mission can contribute to the Product & Engineering team.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Simon Chen